

Impact High · Difficulty Hard · Misuse risk Medium

THE MOVE

Pause before answering -> Use silence as a signal — not a void -> Let them fill it sometimes

START HERE

Before answering your next difficult question, take one full silent beat before speaking. Notice what happens.

SAY THIS

Silence Bridges	<i>"[One breath pause] My honest answer is..."</i>
Invite to Fill	<i>"[Ask question. Pause. Wait fully before adding anything.]"</i>
Beat Buyers	<i>"Good question — let me think."</i>
Considered Pause Fr...	<i>"I am going to take a moment before I respond to that."</i>
Naming the Silence	<i>"That silence was me thinking, not disagreeing."</i>

AVOID

- When silence will be read as not knowing the answer rather than thinking.
- In casual social conversations where silence signals awkwardness rather than composure.
- When the other person is in distress and silence feels like abandonment.

REMEMBER

Count the pause in their time, not yours.